

Slippay: A Portable Governance Layer for the Agent Economy

Extended Abstract for NEAR X

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The thesis in one line

Agent *payment* is solved; agent *governance* is not — and governance is the layer NEAR’s “Currency of Agents” needs to be trusted at scale. Slippay is a working, chain-agnostic governance primitive for it, with a transaction hash behind the claim.

What is already solved (so we don’t reinvent it)

Over HTTP 402, autonomous agents already pay each other in stablecoins: Coinbase/Cloudflare’s **x402** has settled 161M+ machine payments ($\approx$ \$43.5M); Google’s **AP2** standardizes human-approved spending *mandates*. NEAR itself routes agent goals across chains via **Intents**, matches work in the **AI Agent Market**, and hardens execution in **TEEs** (IronClaw / Intel TDX). The rails and the routing exist.

What is NOT solved — the governance gap

When *both* sides of a transaction are autonomous and no human clicked, three questions stay open, and they are the ones that decide whether an agent economy is investable and compliant:

1. **Holder / titularity.** Who is the legal holder of the transaction? Multi-agent liability law is openly unsettled (Berkeley Tech. Law J., Columbia CLS, 2026).
2. **Integrity.** Is the paying agent still uncompromised, or hijacked into an unauthorized payment (llms.txt / prompt injection)?
3. **Bound provenance.** Is the agent’s spending limit *proven*, or just a runtime check a compromised server could skip?

These are one problem: the *self-governance* of an autonomous payer.

Slippay’s answer (and why it is proven, not a slide)

We treat payment authorization as a **metacognitive monitor–control loop**: a payment settles only when a monitor confirms the agent is inside a human-rooted, signed surface, and that verdict is itself a portable, checkable artifact. Three mechanisms, all **non-custodial** (the agent’s own wallet signs; no platform holds funds):

- **Agent-Integrity Attestation (AIA).** An ed25519 verdict —“is this agent inside its committed surface?”— bound to the payment, verifiable *on-chain and offline* by anyone, fail-closed. Not a platform-locked guardrail.
- **AXL proof-carrying bound.** The spending limit compiles to an SMT (z3) certificate anyone can re-verify offline: the agent *cannot* exceed the cap, provably.
- **Human principal at the root.** One signed mandate is the authorization; consent exists without a per-transaction click (aligned with UETA/E-SIGN deployer-as-principal and AP2’s mandate chains).

Demonstrated end-to-end on Stellar mainnet — a buyer agent paid a seller agent inside its mandate, with no human in the loop, and received the good:

Autonomous A2A payment	Stellar mainnet	34eb71b1...ea13b (ledger 63,206,144)
Full loop incl. delivery	Stellar testnet	61db50c6...1d55f1 (ledger 3,291,957)

Why this fits NEAR specifically

NEAR is building the *cross-chain* agent economy; Slippay’s verdict is **chain-agnostic by construction** — the same signed bytes verify on a Soroban contract and off-chain on any stack, so it travels with the agent across the chains NEAR Intents route over.

- **Complements NEAR’s TEE bet, doesn’t compete with it.** TEEs answer “trust the execution environment.” Slippay answers “verify the claim” — a portable cryptographic attestation + a proven bound that hold *without* trusting the host. Combined: a TEE attests, Slippay’s portable verdict carries that trust cross-chain and gates settlement.
- **The governance layer the Agent Market needs.** Escrowed, autonomous task-payment becomes safe when each payout is integrity-gated and mandate-bounded — exactly Slippay’s gate.
- **Regulatory tailwind.** Brazil’s DeCripto (IN 2,291, Jul 2026) and the OECD CARF (70+ countries) oblige identification + reporting while carving out *self-custody*. A cross-chain agent economy faces this globally; the payments that survive are non-custodial, mandate-bounded and auditable — Slippay’s exact shape.

The ask

A conversation about making this the **open governance layer for NEAR’s agent economy**: a pilot wiring the AIA + proof-carrying mandate into a NEAR Intents / Agent-Market flow, and/or an ecosystem grant to harden the chain-agnostic attestation across NEAR’s cross-chain execution. We bring a proven primitive (on-chain, today) and the research behind it; NEAR brings the agent economy that needs it.

Applied paper: *Slippay — Metacognitive Governance for Autonomous Agent Payments: Non-Custodial, Integrity-Gated, Proof-Carrying Settlement on Stellar*. <https://github.com/Galmanus/slippay/blob/main/docs/paper/slippay.pdf>

Foundational paper: *Metacognitive Engineering as a Security Surface: Introspective Vulnerabilities in Large Language Model Alignment* (41 pp). <https://github.com/Galmanus/slippay/blob/main/docs/paper/metacognitive-security.pdf>

Code (open): <https://github.com/Galmanus/slippay> | **Live:** <https://app.slippay.cc>

Honest positioning: agent payment is not novel (x402/AP2 cited); the contribution is the integrity-gated, proof-carrying, metacognitive synthesis and a publicly verifiable artifact.